

Jar App — Product Teardown

Company	Jar
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1. About the Company

Jar was established in 2021 in Bengaluru — a fintech platform helping users save from ₹10 in digital gold via its Daily Save feature.

Jar earns a margin on gold transactions, and has also launched Nek, a drop-shipping jewellery platform reported externally as a major revenue contributor.

I picked Jar for this teardown from 5-6 months of first-hand use.

2. Problem Statements

- When a user opens Jar, it goes straight to the homepage where investment info is visible — anyone with access to an unlocked phone can see it.
- After increasing their Daily Save amount, a user cannot reduce it back down — only fully stop/restart (Fig 2a), not lower to a smaller non-zero figure. Multiple interviewed users confirmed the floor ratchets with whichever amount they've reached (₹50/day, ₹100/day) and only moves up, never back down. See Section 8.

Screenshots — Problem 1 (No App Lock)

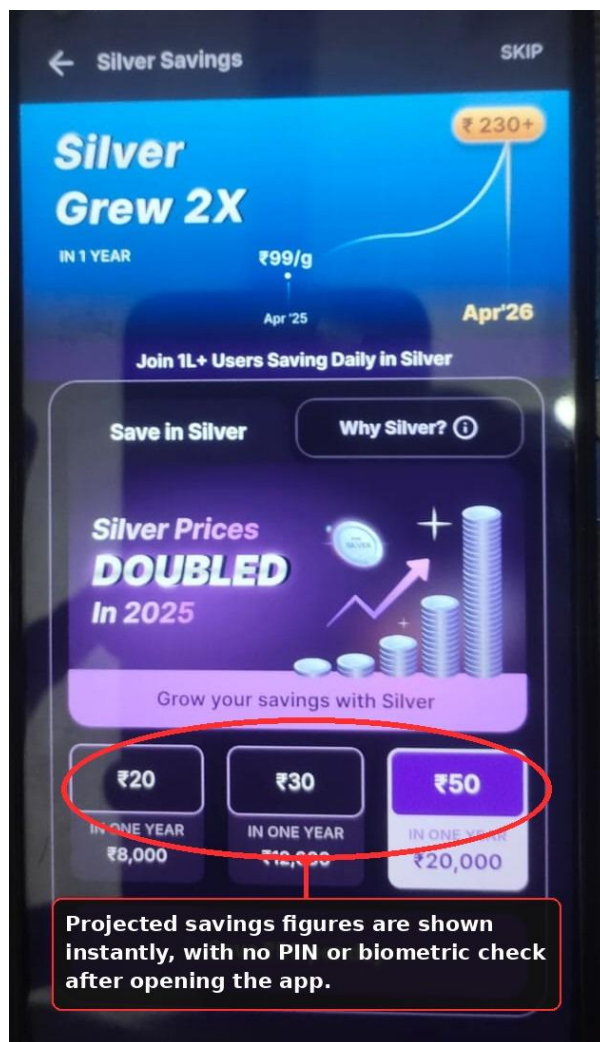
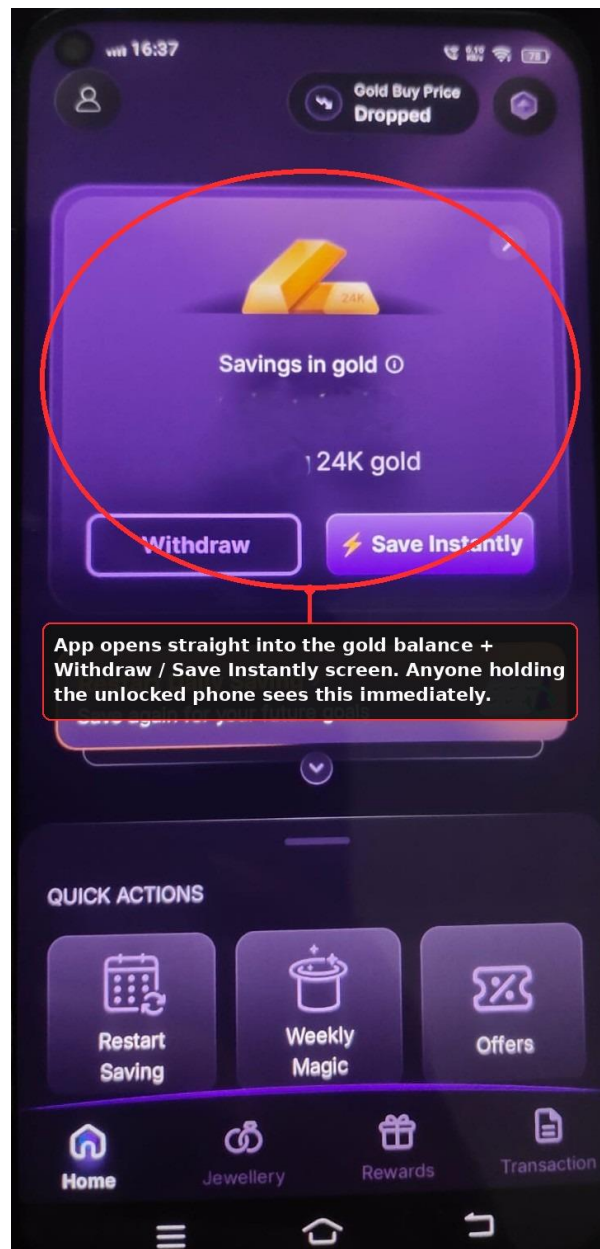


Fig 1a: Savings projections shown instantly on open, no auth step.



App opens straight into the gold balance + Withdraw / Save Instantly screen. Anyone holding the unlocked phone sees this immediately.

Fig 1b: Gold balance + Withdraw/Save Instantly visible immediately on the home screen.

Screenshots — Problem 2 (Cannot Reduce Daily Save)

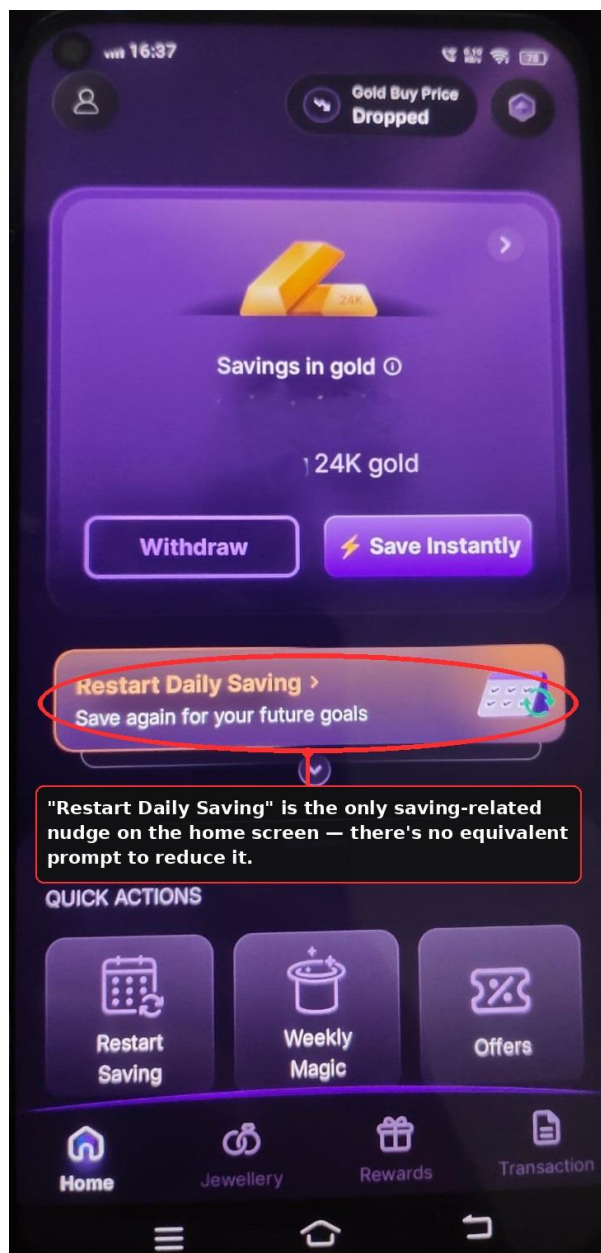


Fig 2a: Home screen only nudges to “Restart Daily Saving” — no decrease option.

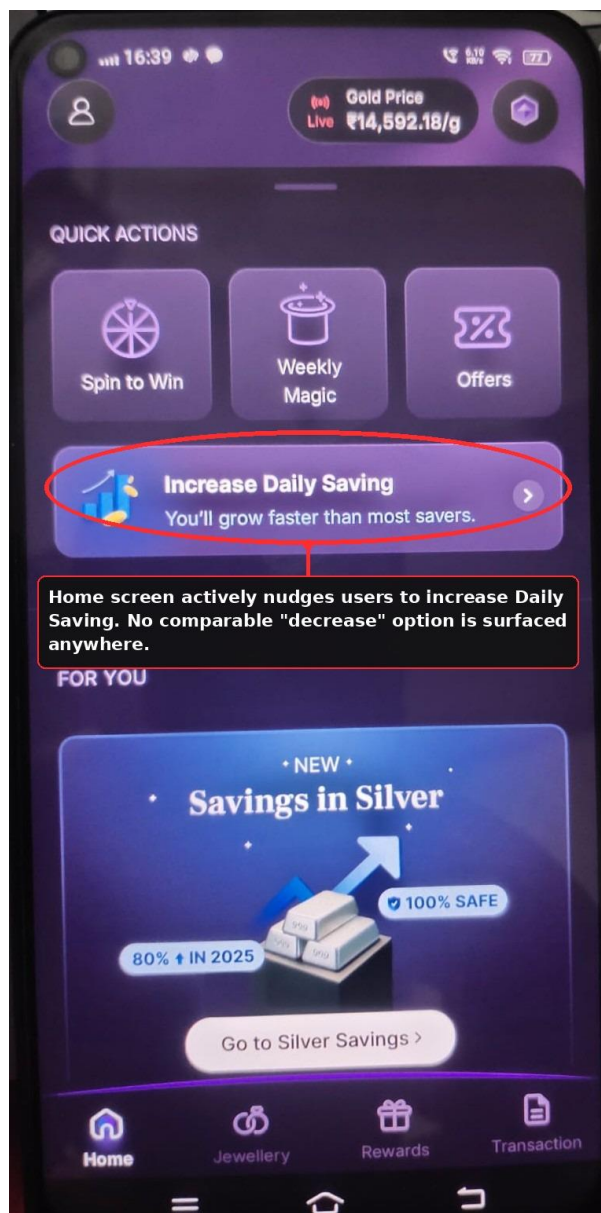


Fig 2b: “Increase Daily Saving” banner — no equivalent decrease prompt.

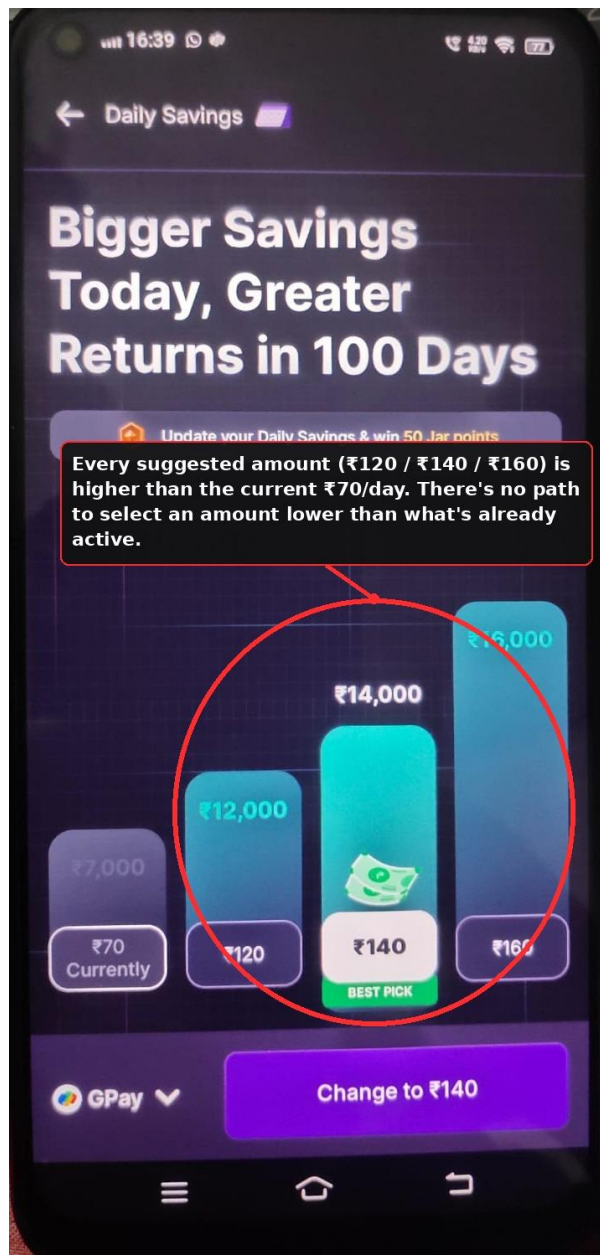


Fig 2c: All suggested amounts are above the current ₹70/day — no lower option.

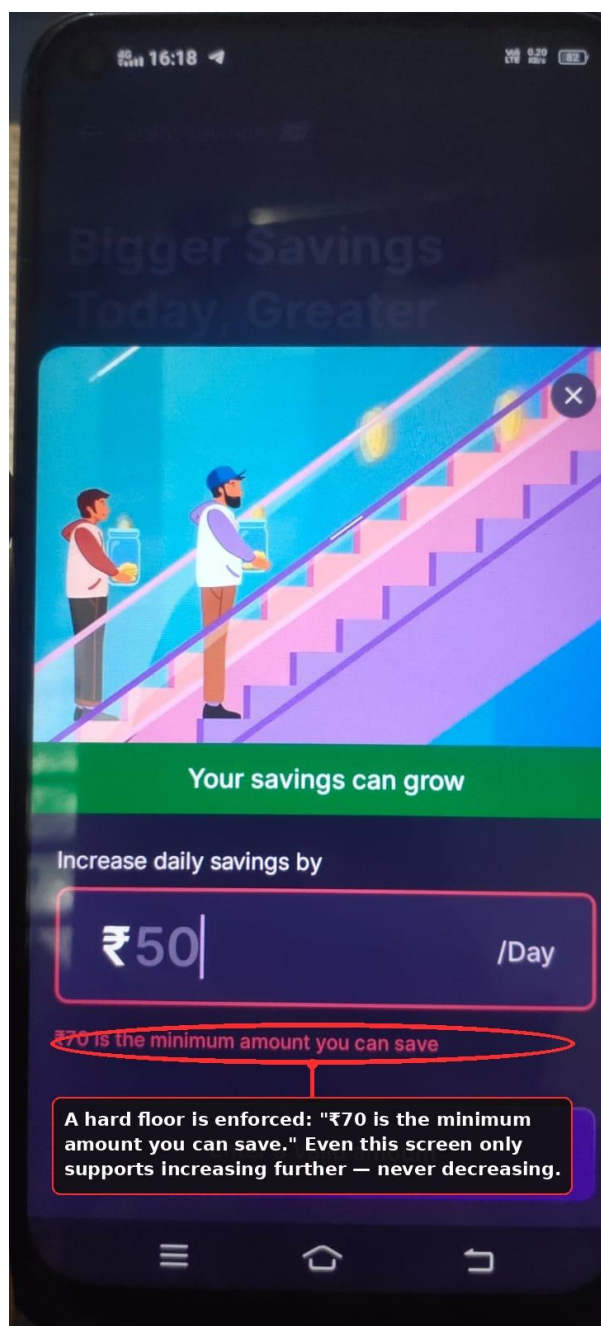


Fig 2d: Hard floor of ₹70/day enforced — only increases are possible from here.

3. User Personas

a) Manasi Sharma

Context: Has been using Jar to invest in gold

Age / Gender / Role / Location: 28 | Female | Data Analyst | Bengaluru

Persona summary: Manasi is saving for her upcoming marriage. Friends and family know her phone password and could unintentionally open Jar and see her savings.

Source: Based directly on one of 28 validated Jar users interviewed for this teardown — one of 15 who raised the app-lock/privacy issue (name changed for privacy) — not a fictionalized composite.

Pain point: No security layer for users when their phone is in someone else's hands.

Expectation: An in-app lock, so only trusted people can view her savings.

b) Arjun Rao

Context: Has been using Jar to invest in gold via the Daily Save plan

Age / Gender / Role / Location: 24 | Male | SWE | Bengaluru

Persona summary: Arjun increased his Daily Save amount once an EMI ended, but wanted to reduce it again when a new EMI began — no option existed.

Source: Based directly on one of 28 validated Jar users interviewed for this teardown — one of 12 who raised the reduce-amount issue (name changed for privacy) — not a fictionalized composite.

Pain point: No option to reduce the Daily Save amount after increasing it.

Expectation: The ability to decrease savings whenever needed.

4. Problem Hypotheses & Trade-offs

① No security when opening the app

Jar likely prioritizes low-friction daily engagement over privacy. OTP/KYC exist elsewhere but only at specific, consequential moments; an app-open lock would add friction to every single session, not just meaningful ones — likely the sharper reason it doesn't exist yet.

Prioritized: Faster access, higher daily active users, smoother UX

Deprioritized: Privacy, if someone else gains access to the unlocked phone

② Cannot reduce the Daily Save amount after increasing it

Jar likely prioritizes habit formation and predictable transaction volume over flexibility. Jar earns margin on gold transactions, so a smaller/paused Daily Save indirectly reduces that margin over time. Keeping increases easy and reductions unavailable protects recurring volume — but risks users who'd reduce temporarily never increasing again.

Prioritized: Higher retention, consistent saving habit, predictable transaction volume

Deprioritized: User control and flexibility to adjust savings as circumstances change

5. What Metrics This Likely Hurts

Users frustrated by the lack of control may move to alternatives such as Spare8 or SafeGold, which could hurt retention and increase churn.

6. Proposed Fixes

① Add an optional in-app lock

Add an optional in-app PIN/biometric lock — opt-in, so it doesn't add friction for users who don't want it, while solving the problem for those who do. See Section 8 for a risk with this framing.

② Allow reducing Daily Save, with a supportive nudge instead of a block

Allow users to reduce their savings amount, framed supportively rather than as a loss — a low-key, non-intrusive in-app prompt (not a push) at 7/15/30 days showing the path back up, positioned as available information, not something pushed at them.

Example: You're ₹30/day away from your previous ₹100/day amount — increasing back anytime takes you right there. (For reference: staying at ₹70/day instead of ₹100/day works out to about ₹913 less over the next month, ₹5,475 less over 6 months, and ₹10,950 less over a year, at 365 days — shown here only as background information, not as the headline of the prompt.)

7. Validation

Validated informally with 28 active Jar users (friends/family/network) via open-ended questions, without naming the problems first. Of 28: 15 raised no-app-lock, 12 raised cannot-reduce, 7 raised other issues (not mutually exclusive, so counts exceed 28). Both problems came up unprompted.

This network skews urban/tech-comfortable relative to Jar's broader ₹10-minimum user base — the RICE scores in Section 9 reflect this: a larger sample raises confidence the pattern is real, not what fraction of Jar's base is affected.

Directional proxy: NSSO 2022-23 data shows a majority of Indian phone users, especially women, share their phone with a family member — suggesting device-sharing (Problem 1) is common, though not Jar-specific data.

Competitor Check — App Lock

Checked Spare8 and SafeGold (closest digital-gold competitors) for an in-app lock — found no evidence either has shipped one, so Jar could be first in-category rather than catching up. The one workaround today is OS-level (Android app-lock/work profile, iOS Screen Time) — higher friction than an in-app toggle.

8. Trade-offs & Risks (Proposed Fixes)

- Opt-in features often go unused. The app lock (Fix ①) avoids added friction, but could see low adoption even among users who'd benefit — worth tracking opt-in rate post-launch.
- The reduce-amount nudge risks feeling punitive if it leads with a rupee-loss figure. Fix ② is written to lead with the path back up instead — a tone decision worth user-testing before shipping.
- The exact ₹70/day figure is from my own account, but the ratcheting mechanism is corroborated by multiple users at different starting amounts. Whether an app lock exists in Settings, and whether stop/restart allows restarting lower, remain unverified.
- The “reduce” problem may be narrower than stated: Fig 2a suggests a full stop/restart already exists, so the real unmet need may be staying enrolled at a lower amount, not lacking control entirely — not explicitly checked in Settings.

9. RICE Prioritization (Hypothesis-Based)

Problem 1: No App Lock / Biometric Authentication

Problem statement: Users who share devices or value privacy do not have an option to add an additional security layer when opening the Jar app.

Factor	Score	Reasoning
Reach	3/5	15 of 28 interviewed users (54%) raised this unprompted (Section 7) — an upper bound from a self-selected network, not Jar's user base. The NSSO device-sharing proxy supports scoring above the floor.
Impact	3/5	Doesn't block saving; plausible effect is on app rating/NPS and trust for shared-device users. No evidence of churn, and OS-level

Factor	Score	Reasoning
		workarounds + no competitor having this either reduce incremental value — but exposure for device-sharing users is real.
Confidence	3/5	Well documented (15/28, no auth on open in screenshots), but Reach/Impact estimates are soft — no Jar-internal data, and Settings wasn't checked for an existing lock (Section 8), which could make this a discoverability issue instead.
Effort	2/5	Standard feature — biometric APIs, fallback PIN, lock-timeout, UI/testing — ~0.5-1 person-month. Optional, so no default-path friction.

RICE Score: $3 \times 3 \times 3 \div 2 = 13.5$

RICE interpretation:

13.5, marginally ahead of Reduce Daily Save's 12 — within the noise of an ordinal scale, treated as tied. Cheap and self-contained, but an existing Settings lock or a narrower affected segment could change its standing.

Problem 2: Unable to Reduce Daily Save Amount After Increasing It

Problem statement: Users can increase their Daily Save amount easily but lack the flexibility to reduce it later, which creates a feeling of reduced control over their own savings decisions.

Factor	Score	Reasoning
Reach	3/5	12 of 28 (43%) raised this unprompted (Section 7) — scored at parity with Problem 1 despite the slightly lower share, since nothing in the evidence separates true reach between them.
Impact	4/5	A real trust moment for affected users (12/28 unprompted). Scored 4 not 5: a full stop appears to exist (Fig 2a, narrower unmet need), no direct churn evidence, and Hypothesis ② means the fix carries a real business trade-off.
Confidence	3/5	Corroborated by 12/28 plus the ratcheting mechanism described independently at different amounts. But the core claim — no path to a lower amount — hasn't been checked in Settings, and the exact ratchet rule is unknown.
Effort	3/5	Build time only: amount-edit flow + floor-rule change + 7/15/30-day catch-up prompt, ~1-2 person-months. Payment-mandate re-registration and the exact floor rule (Section 8) could push this up; reversing a deliberate business choice is a separate organizational risk, not build effort.

RICE Score: $3 \times 4 \times 3 \div 3 = 12$

RICE interpretation:

12, effectively tied with App Lock's 13.5 — higher Impact offset by higher Effort. RICE can't separate the two; sequencing rests on the reasons below.

10. Prioritization Conclusion

Problem	Priority
Reduce Daily Save amount	Sequenced first, on qualitative grounds (RICE Score: 12, tied)
App Lock	Sequenced second (RICE Score: 13.5, tied)

RICE ties the two (13.5 vs 12, within ordinal noise). I'd sequence Daily Save flexibility first — it sits on the core saving journey and connects to retention/transaction volume, unlike the lock, and affects users who've already built trust and committed financially. This depends on one open check: if Settings shows stop-and-restart already allows a lower amount, this becomes a discoverability issue and App Lock should go first. App Lock stays a close, cheap second.